

Hook Iteration

Same woman. Same scene. Same reason it works. A different way in.

Control Maggie, the 14 month wait
Test Three doors into the same room
Moves 0 layers, 1 beat

The layers nothing moves

Layer	Control	Test	
ICP	Surgery Candidate	Identical	KEEP
Use Case	14 month wait for a hip replacement	Identical	KEEP
Angle, belief shift	Bone is not the whole story, the tissue is starved and stuck	Identical	KEEP
Angle, emotion	Something irreversible is coming at me	Identical	KEEP
Awareness	Problem Aware	Identical	KEEP
Bucket	Static	Identical	KEEP
Format	Native article, long	Identical	KEEP
Length	Around 1,100 words	Identical	KEEP
Audience, budget, page, LP	Unchanged	Identical	KEEP

This is what makes an iteration an iteration. Not one layer of the master concept moves. Same person, same situation, same belief shift, same stage, same bucket, same format. If any row above changes, you are running a new concept and it gets named NN.

Beat by beat 1 change - 17 keep

Beat	In your script		Why	Sample
1 Hook	The 14 month wait, best thing that ever happened	CHANGE	The only thing being tested. Three doors into the same room.	"I sat on the edge of my bed for eleven minutes, holding a sock."
2 Credential	My name is Maggie, I'm 64	KEEP	Same narrator	Word for word

Beat	In your script		Why	Sample
3 Personal Crisis	The kerb, 0 to 9, 6am	KEEP	Same origin	Word for word
4 Pattern	Car, chair, bed, the sock, the nights	KEEP	Same losses. Note the sock already lives here	Word for word
6 Failed Attempts	Doctor, X ray, surgeon, waiting list	KEEP	Same scene	Word for word
7 Low Point	John doing the groceries	KEEP	Same cost at home	Word for word
7 Low Point	Crying in the driveway about the date	KEEP	Same trigger	Word for word
6 Failed Attempts	2am googling, TENS, pillow, physio	KEEP	Same searches	Word for word
8 Bridge	Denise arrives	KEEP	Same discovery	Word for word
10 Mechanism	Tendons, blood supply, stuck loop	KEEP	The control	Word for word
12 Differentiation	Not numbing, not masking, not loading	KEEP	Same argument	Word for word
13 Product Intro	The belt, four things at once	KEEP	Same product	Word for word
18 Guarantee	30 day money back, said by her	KEEP	Same risk reversal	Word for word
14 Results	Twenty minutes, four hours, kerb, socks	KEEP	Same results	Word for word
14 Results	Hospital rings to confirm the date	KEEP	Same resolution	Word for word
17 CTA	Dreading a date on a calendar	KEEP	Same reader	Word for word
17 CTA	Try it yourself	KEEP	Same close	Word for word
19 Echo Close	I wish someone had told me eighteen months ago	KEEP	Generic enough to survive all three doors. Leave it alone	Word for word

One beat. That is the whole test. Compare that with the use case swap, where six beats moved. The size of the change is how you know which test you are running.

Sample output three doors

Every door lands on the same bridge line and then runs into the identical body copy. Only the opening changes.

DOOR A - THE SOCK

CONTROL HOOK

The 14 month wait for my hip replacement turned out to be the best thing that ever happened to me, because by my surgery date I no longer needed it.

I still haven't told my surgeon that.

DOOR A

I sat on the edge of my bed for eleven minutes one morning, holding a sock.

Sixty four years old, and I could not reach my own foot.

That was the morning I stopped telling myself it would settle down on its own.

WHY OPENS ON AN OBJECT IN ONE MOMENT, WITH NO STORY BUILT FIRST. SAME SHAPE AS THE STRONGEST OPENING IN THE ACCOUNT. RISK THE SOCK IS PROVEN AS A PAYOFF 700 WORDS IN. IT IS UNPROVEN AS A COLD OPENING. THAT GAP IS THE WHOLE POINT OF THE TEST.

DOOR B - NINETY SECONDS

CONTROL HOOK

The 14 month wait for my hip replacement turned out to be the best thing that ever happened to me, because by my surgery date I no longer needed it.

I still haven't told my surgeon that.

DOOR B

My surgeon looked at my scan for about ninety seconds.

Then he said four words that put a date on the rest of my year.

"It's bone on bone."

WHY OPENS AT THE DECISION POINT, WHICH IS WHERE THREE OF THE SEVEN WINNERS ALREADY SIT. RISK BONE ON BONE IS GROUND THE CLIENT HAS ALREADY TESTED. CLOSEST TO THE CONTROL, SO EXPECT THE SMALLEST DIFFERENCE.

DOOR C - 4:45 IN THE MORNING

CONTROL HOOK

The 14 month wait for my hip replacement turned out to be the best thing that ever happened to me, because by my surgery date I no longer needed it.

I still haven't told my surgeon that.

DOOR C

For most of last year I gave up on sleep around 4:45 in the morning.

I'd sit in the dark kitchen with a heat pack on my hip, waiting for the sky to go grey.

Nobody tells you that the worst part of a bad hip is the hours nobody sees.

WHY OPENS ON NIGHT PAIN, THE SINGLE BIGGEST THEME IN THE REVIEW CORPUS, AND THE ONE NO AD HAS EVER LED WITH. RISK FURTHEST FROM THE CONTROL, SO IT IS THE HIGHEST VARIANCE DOOR. SLEEP HAS 11 ANGLE CARDS AND ZERO WINNERS BEHIND IT.

Then all three continue: But if you're reading this with that deep ache in the side of your hip right now, you need to hear how I got here.

Old script vs iterated script door A

Struck through on the left is what came out. Underlined on the right is what went in. Everything else is identical, which is the point.

1 - HOOK

CONTROL

The 14 month wait for my hip replacement turned out to be the best thing that ever happened to me, because by my surgery date I no longer needed it.

I still haven't told my surgeon that.

But if you're reading this with that deep ache in the side of your hip right now, you need to hear how I got here.

NEW

I sat on the edge of my bed for eleven minutes one morning, holding a sock.

Sixty four years old, and I could not reach my own foot.

That was the morning I stopped telling myself it would settle down on its own.

But if you're reading this with that deep ache in the side of your hip right now, you need to hear how I got here.

2 - CREDENTIAL

CONTROL

My name is Maggie.

I'm 64.

And eighteen months ago I honestly believed my life as I knew it was over.

NEW

My name is Maggie.

I'm 64.

And eighteen months ago I honestly believed my life as I knew it was over.

3 - PERSONAL CRISIS

CONTROL

It didn't start with a fall or an accident.

Just a dull soreness on the outside of my right hip that I was sure would go away on its own.

It didn't.

One morning I went to step off the kerb outside my house and my hip just gave out.

The pain jumped from 0 to 9 in a second.

I grabbed the fence so hard I scraped my palm, standing there in my dressing gown at 6am, thinking, what is happening to me.

After that day, the pain never really left.

It moved into my life like it owned the place.

NEW

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4 - PATTERN

CONTROL

Getting out of the car became a project I had to plan.

I could barely walk, get up and down out of a chair, the bed or the toilet.

It was horrible.

I'll be honest about the thing that humiliated me the most.

I could no longer put my own socks on without wanting to scream.

Sixty four years old and beaten by a sock.

But the nights were the worst part.

The absolute worst.

I couldn't lie on my right side anymore.

The second my hip touched the mattress it felt like someone pressing their thumb into a deep bruise.

So I'd roll to my left.

Then my left would start.

I'd wake up and not be able to go back to sleep.

I'd lay there and toss and turn, sometimes for hours.

Most nights I gave up around 4:45 and just sat in the dark kitchen with a heat pack, waiting for the sky to go grey.

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7 - LOW POINT, AT HOME

CONTROL

I used to be the one who organised everything.

Family gatherings.

Birthdays.

Now I was the woman in the car park doing the maths on whether I could make it to the shops and back without having to stop and hold onto something.

My husband John started doing the grocery runs without telling me, so I wouldn't feel like I had to come along.

I noticed.

I didn't say anything.

But it broke something in me.

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6 - FAILED ATTEMPTS, THE VERDICT

CONTROL

So I did what you're supposed to do.

I went to the doctor.

He pressed on my hip, sent me for an X-ray, and a week later gave me the verdict.

Osteoarthritis.

The cartilage was wearing thin.

"It's fairly common at your age, Maggie."

At your age.

I wanted to scream.

He gave me anti inflammatories that wrecked my stomach and barely touched the pain.

When I went back, he sent me to an orthopaedic surgeon.

The surgeon looked at my scan for about ninety seconds.

Pointed at the gap on the screen.

Said the words I'll never forget.

"It's bone on bone. We'll want to replace that."

And just like that, I was on a waiting list.

Fourteen months.

He offered me a cortisone injection to get me through until then.

NEW

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7 - LOW POINT, THE DATE

CONTROL

I drove home and cried in the driveway.

Not because of the surgery exactly.

Because of the date.

There was now a date hanging over my whole life, and a 14 month countdown of pain to survive before it.

NEW

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There was now a date hanging over my whole life, and a 14 month countdown of pain to survive before it.

6 - FAILED ATTEMPTS, THE 2AM SEARCH

CONTROL

That's when the 2am googling started.

If you've done it, you know exactly what I mean.

Phone screen too bright.

John asleep beside me.

Typing things like "hip pain can't sleep" and "bone on bone alternatives" and, on the dark nights, "how bad is hip replacement recovery."

I read everything.

I bought a TENS machine that did nothing.

I bought a special pillow.

I tried the physio exercises off the photocopied sheet, and I swear my hip got angrier, not better.

I was willing to try everything.

Stretches, tennis ball, over the counter meds, heat packs, physical therapy, anything to stop me wincing every time I stood up.

And still, nobody was answering the one question I actually had.

Why did this happen so fast, and is there anything that actually heals it instead of just numbing it.

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8 - BRIDGE

CONTROL

The answer came from the most unlikely place.

My sister in law, Denise.

A retired theatre nurse.

Sharp as a tack and not one for nonsense.

She came over for a cup of tea, watched me lever myself out of the armchair using both arms, and went quiet.

Then she said something that genuinely annoyed me at the time.

"Maggie, has anyone actually told you what's gone wrong in there, or did they just point at the bone?"

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"Maggie, has anyone actually told you what's gone wrong in there, or did they just point at the bone?"

10 - MECHANISM

CONTROL

I said the surgeon told me.

Bone on bone.

And she said, "That's the joint. That's not why you can't sleep on your side. That's not why it stabs the second you stand up."

Then she explained the thing not one doctor had bothered to.

She said the sharp pain on the outside of the hip, the can't lie on it pain, very often isn't the cartilage at all.

It's the soft tissue around the joint.

The tendons that anchor the muscles to the outside of your hip.

She said as we get older, and especially for us women around menopause, those tendons lose their blood supply and their ability to repair themselves.

They get inflamed.

And then they get stuck in a loop where they simply stop healing.

Here's the part that made me sit up straight.

She said the reason the painkillers and the rest never worked was that none of them touched that.

They quieten the alarm.

They don't get fresh blood and repair into a starved tendon that has stopped fixing itself.

And you can't stretch your way out of it either, because loading an angry tendon just inflames it more.

Which explained, finally, why that physio sheet made everything worse.

For the first time in months, something actually made sense.

The problem wasn't only a worn out joint waiting for the scalpel.

The problem was tissue that had been starved of circulation and left stuck in inflammation, and nothing I'd tried was bringing it back to life.

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12 - DIFFERENTIATION

CONTROL

So I went looking for the opposite of everything I'd been doing.

Not numbing.

Not masking.

Not loading it.

Something that would actually drive warmth and blood and repair into that exact spot.

NEW

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13 - PRODUCT INTRODUCTION

CONTROL

What I found was a therapy belt that wraps right around the hip and does four things at once.

Red and near infrared light that sinks down into the tissue.

Gentle heat.

A soft vibration massage.

And a light compression that holds it all exactly where the pain lives.

NEW

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Gentle heat.

A soft vibration massage.

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18 - GUARANTEE

CONTROL

I'll be honest with you.

After everything that had failed, I expected nothing.

I only bought it because it came with a 30 day money back promise, so I figured I could send it back and feel smug about it.

NEW

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I only bought it because it came with a 30 day money back promise, so I figured I could send it back and feel smug about it.

14 - PERSONAL RESULTS

CONTROL

The first night I used it for twenty minutes in my armchair while the news was on.

The warmth alone was the nicest my hip had felt in a year.

I went to bed thinking, well, at least that was pleasant.

I slept four hours on my right side.

The side I had not slept on in over a year.

I cried again.

A very different reason this time.

I won't pretend it was instant magic.

It wasn't.

But over the next few weeks, twenty minutes a day, the change was undeniable.

The morning stiffness got shorter.

The stab when I stepped off the kerb softened to a murmur, then most days, to nothing.

I got down on the floor with my granddaughter and got back up without the two armed push up off the couch.

I put my own socks on one morning and didn't even think about it until I was halfway out the door.

NEW

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14 - PERSONAL RESULTS, THE RESOLUTION

CONTROL

By the time the hospital rang to confirm my surgery date, I sat there with the phone in my hand and realised I genuinely didn't want it anymore.

I think about what that 14 month wait nearly cost me.

Not just the operation.

The mornings with my grandkids I was too sore to enjoy.

The walks with John I kept saying no to.

The nights of sleep I will never get back.

That's the part that still gets me.

Not the pain.

The lost time.

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17 - CTA

CONTROL

I'm not a doctor.

I'm just a woman who was handed a date and a countdown, and stumbled onto the thing nobody had explained to me.

So if you're lying awake right now with that ache on the side of your hip, dreading a date on a calendar, I want you to know something.

The bone might not be the whole story.

There may be something starved and inflamed around that joint that nobody has properly looked at, and it may not be as finished as you have been told.

NEW

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19 - ECHO CLOSE

CONTROL

I wish someone had told me eighteen months ago.

So now I'm telling you.

Try it yourself.

NEW

I wish someone had told me eighteen months ago.

So now I'm telling you.

Try it yourself.

The image one per door

Every image in this account so far is text on a plain background. Zero symptom images have ever run, despite the copy handing over the sock, the letter, the heat pack. So each direction below is untested here. One image per script, no backups, no options. The method's own rule: show the most interesting concrete thing in the script. Never an idea, never a text overlay, and on cold traffic never the product, because the belt has not been earned yet.

The rule. The image comes from whatever the hook names. Not from the use case as a category, not from the pain point as a category. From the hook. That is why the method says finish the headline first: a changed headline voids its image direction.

If the hook names	The image comes from	Beat
The situation she is in	The use case	1 and 6
A thing she can no longer do	The pain point	4
Why the last treatment failed	The explanation	10
A number or a result	The proof	14
The offer or the price	The product	13

The gate that overrules it. Awareness. If the two disagree, awareness wins. Problem aware and cold: the use case or the pain point, and never the product because it has not been earned. Solution aware: the explanation, the diagram, the depth. Most aware: the product and the offer, never a symptom. Every script on this page is problem aware, so the belt never appears.

The pattern, four steps. 1. Read the hook. 2. Circle every noun you could photograph. 3. If there is more than one, take the most specific and the least expected. 4. That noun is the image, alone in the frame, nothing else.

Hook	The noun it sticks to	Source
"I was on a waiting list. Fourteen months."	the waiting list	Use case
"I had two injections left in that hip."	the injections	Use case
"Eleven minutes, holding a sock."	the sock	Pain point
"Looked at my scan for about ninety seconds."	the scan	Use case
"Sat in the dark kitchen with a heat pack."	the heat pack	Pain point

Two tests before you shoot. The swap test: could this image sit on any other ad in the category? If yes, it is not specific enough, go back to step 3. The loop test: does the image answer the question or ask it? It has to ask. An image that gives away the ending kills the reason to read.

Script	The line it comes from	The image	Level	Hypothesis
Control the 14 month wait	"And just like that, I was on a waiting list. Fourteen months."	The hospital letter, still in its envelope, unopened on the kitchen bench. A pen beside it.	1	The baseline. Every door below is measured against this one, and all four run the same body copy underneath.
Door A the sock	"I sat on the edge of my bed for eleven minutes, holding a sock."	One sock on the floor beside the edge of an unmade bed, early morning light through the curtain. Nothing else in frame. No person, no hands.	2	If a sock on the floor stops her with no context at all, the account has a scroll stopper that costs nothing to shoot and nobody else in the category is using. The risk is real: the sock is proven as a payoff 700 words into a winning ad, and completely unproven as a cold opening.

Script	The line it comes from	The image	Level	Hypothesis
Door B ninety seconds	"My surgeon looked at my scan for about ninety seconds."	The hip X-ray on a consulting room screen, one finger pointing at the joint gap. Shot over the shoulder. No face, no name on the scan.	2	This is closest to the control, so expect the smallest difference. It tells you whether the decision point is still the strongest entry into this market, or whether three winners sitting there have already worn it out.
Door C 4:45 in the morning	"Most nights I gave up around 4:45 and sat in the dark kitchen with a heat pack."	A dark kitchen before dawn. One light on over the bench. A heat pack left on the chair. Empty room, no person.	2	Night pain is the single biggest theme in the review corpus and no ad has ever led with it. Furthest from the control, so the highest variance of the three. If it wins, sleep is a doorway worth its own concept, not just a hook.

Run the image test before the copy tests. Same winning ad, same headline, text card against the concrete photo. That is one clean variable and it answers the biggest open question in the account. Then run the copy tests on whichever image style won. If you change the image and the copy in the same round, you will not know which one moved the number.

KTA act on these

- Move one beat. If a second beat moved, you are not iterating, you are writing a new concept.
- Keep the bridge line into the body identical across every door. That is the seam, and it has to hold.
- Do not touch the echo close. This one is generic enough to survive all three openings, so leave it alone.
- Run all three doors at once against the control. Hooks are the cheapest thing you will ever test.
- Name them ITE and bump the version. Same angle code, same batch. Only the version moves.
- Judge on click through first, then CPA. A door can win attention and still lose the sale.

Same ad. New front door.

An iteration does not move the concept. It only changes who stops to read it.

Guide 02 of 3. Guide 01 is the Use Case Swap, where the scene moves and six beats go with it. Guide 03 is the Angle Swap, where the scene holds still and the belief shift changes.